MTP F26 · TEAM C · RADIO TEAM

Radio brief: band, module and link budget

Team Santiago, Andrian, Marcos **Version** 0.6 · Fri 16 Oct 2026 **Next session** Fri 23 Oct (week 5)

New in v0.6 (16 Oct, proposal): a teacher said we might qualify for **20 dBm e.i.r.p.** We do, but only as a **frequency-hopping radio with listen-before-talk** (CNAF UN-85 a), EN 300 328 adaptive FHSS). Same SP4 and omni, a new firmware mode for SRI and MRM, **+10.5 dB on every link**. It is a draft (D-R6) until Atenea Q3 says yes. See 20 dBm with frequency hopping.

New in v0.5 (decided 13 Oct, Santiago with Marcos): one omni antenna per box on the Ebyte E01-ML01SP4. Antennas cannot change between the competition modes, and the patches' risks in NM (aiming, the rim corner, tuning) outweighed their +1 dB on MRM. The SP4 has the antenna socket on the module, so the flex omni plugs straight in. Shopping list updated below.

New in v0.4: all four teams agreed to run **every mode at 2.4 GHz**, so 868 MHz is dropped. The radio is now the **Ebyte E01-ML01DP5** (Nordic nRF24L01+ with PA and LNA) at 250 kbps, with **two patch antennas** per box and our own channel in MRM. **Do not order the Adafruit RFM69 or the Molex antennas**; the new shopping list is below. **Order by Fri 16 Oct.**

Every figure carries a tag: `RULE` from the competition rules PDF, `VERIFIED` against a primary source, `ASSUMPTION` to be replaced by a measurement, and `ESTIMATE`.

Bottom line

1. **2.4 GHz is the right band for this competition.** In MRM all teams transmit at once `RULE`. At 868 MHz four teams would share one 250 kHz channel (about a quarter of 67 kbps each). At 2.4 GHz each team gets its own channel, there is no duty-cycle limit, and NM has one common radio for everybody.
2. **The price is margin.** The limit is 10 mW e.i.r.p. (CNAF UN-85 b) `VERIFIED`. With the SP4 and one omni, at 0.75 m: **SRI 70 m +26 dB, MRM 260 m +3.4 dB, NM 100 m hop +9.9 dB**, against +36.7 / +13.9 / +20.5 dB at 868 MHz.

3. **MRM at 260 m is the thin link.** Two levers: antennas 25 cm higher give +5 dB, and **20 dBm with frequency hopping** (D-R6 draft, needs a yes to Atenea Q3) gives **+10.5 dB**: MRM 260 m from +3.4 to **+13.9 dB**, with the same hardware.
4. **Speed is no longer a problem.** 250 kbps gives ~159 kbps of goodput. The simulator delivers the whole file in 28 s at 5 % loss, and all 10,000 lines even without compression (73 s).
5. **One omni, decided.** Plugged straight into the SP4 (no adapter) and with the SP4's −96 dBm sensitivity, it is only 1 dB behind the two-patch build on MRM, with none of the patches' NM risks. Remaining risk: if T0 measures only ~+2 dBm out of the module, every link loses ~5 dB.
6. **MRM channel plan for the four teams:** RF_CH 24 / 49 / 74 / 82. A neighbouring box 2 m away can arrive 55 dB above our 260 m signal, so the channels sit 25 MHz apart where possible and the two closest teams need 10 m between boxes.

Working baseline sign-off pending

The **E01-ML01SP4** is a genuine Nordic nRF24L01+ with a PA and an LNA, as a 14.85 × 18 mm SMD module with an **IPEX (U.FL) antenna socket**. Datasheet: +20 dBm max, **−96 dBm at 250 kbps**, 120 mA TX, 26 mA RX, 2.0–3.6 V `VERIFIED`. Its lowest power setting gives about **+2 to +7 dBm**, depending on the PA gain; test T0 measures it before any field test `ASSUMPTION`. With the 3 dBi peak of the omni that is at most 9.5 dBm e.i.r.p. The driver refuses any higher power setting.

Four radio profiles are generated by `radio/phy_config.py`. Each is checked against the band edges (Carson bandwidth plus ±60 ppm crystal drift per box) and the 10 dBm e.i.r.p. limit for its antenna path.

PROFILE	USE	CHANNEL	RATE	AT SMA	ANTENNA PATH
TEAM_250K	Our own link: SRI, QM, MRM	74 · 2474 MHz	250 kbps	≤ +7 dBm	omni 3 dBi peak, −0.5 dB

PROFILE	USE	CHANNEL	RATE	AT SMA	ANTENNA PATH
TEAM_1M	SRI option (teams take turns)	74 · 2474 MHz	1 Mbps	≤ +7 dBm	omni 3 dBi peak, −0.5 dB
NM_COMMON	Shared with all teams (below)	80 · 2480 MHz	250 kbps	≤ +7 dBm	omni 3 dBi peak, −0.5 dB
TEAM_FHSS	SRI/MRM hopping with listen-before-talk (D-R6 draft)	29 hops · 2402–2476	250 kbps	≤ +13 dBm (−12)	omni 3 dBi peak, −0.5 dB

No duty-cycle limit

UN-85 b) has no duty-cycle condition, so the 3-rounds-per-hour limit of 868 MHz is gone. Test as often as we like. The firmware's duty-cycle guard was removed.

The power limit is the only rule to watch. The driver **refuses any setting above RF_PWR −18 dBm**: at full power the module would radiate about 20× the limit.

Firmware ready before the hardware

A portable C driver for the nRF24L01+ passes 194 host checks against a simulated radio, including two radios talking over a simulated channel, the power limit, and the listen-before-talk rules of the hopping mode. It needs five board functions (SPI select and transfer, CE pin, microsecond delay and clock).

Frames use dynamic length and the radio's CRC, and go out without the chip's own ACKs, so our ARQ stays in charge. The protocol simulator runs on it: 13 of 13 scenarios pass, two of them hopping.

Antenna

One Molex 146153-0100 flex dipole per box (34.9 × 9 mm, 2.4–3.0 dBi peak, > 66 %

efficiency), plugged into the SP4's socket, stuck **vertically** as high as possible on a side wall. The same antenna serves SRI, MRM and NM, and Quick Mode too.

The model uses 2 dBi in the box `ASSUMPTION`; test T5 measures it.

What to buy (order by Fri 16 Oct)

ITEM	QTY	PRICE	WHY
Ebyte E01-ML01SP4 (nRF24L01P + PA/LNA, SMD, IPEX)	6	verify	2 boxes, 2 for the bench, 2 spares. Modules shown at Quick Mode are final, so buy them all from one batch, and check the EU seller and lead time first.
Molex 146153-0100 flex omni, 100 mm cable, U.FL	4	≈ €2–4	The antenna. Check the part is the MHF (U.FL) version, not MHF4.
U.FL-to-SMA-female pigtail	2	€2–3	To measure the module on the spectrum analyser (T0, T13).

Do not buy Ebyte E01C-* parts or no-name "nRF24L01+PA+LNA" boards: Ebyte's own manual says the E01C uses the Si24R1 clone chip. The SP4 is SMD, so it needs a small breakout (or the carrier PCB) from the first bench test. Not needed any more: the DP5, SMA pads and whips.

Antenna: one omni

decided 13 Oct

The antennas cannot change between SRI, MRM and NM, so one build has to serve all three. The comparison we decided on, model at 0.75 m (the first row is the decision; the others are the 9 Oct options):

BUILD	E.I.R.P.	SRI 70 M	MRM 260 M	MRM AT 1.0 M	NM 100 M, −10 DB
SP4 + one omni, plugged straight in (decided)	8.5 dBm	+26.0	+3.4	+8.3	+9.9
DP5 + two patches, 4.5 dBi (not chosen)	10.0 dBm	+27.0	+4.4	+9.3	+10.9

BUILD	E.I.R.P.	SRI 70 M	MRM 260 M	MRM AT 1.0 M	NM 100 M, −10 DB
DP5 + one omni 2 dBi, via adapter	8.0 dBm	+23.0	+0.4	+5.3	+6.9
One omni straight on the SMA	8.7 dBm	+24.4	+1.8	+6.7	+8.3
One omni, 0 dBi inside the box	6.0 dBm	+19.0	−3.6	+1.3	+2.9
SP4 + one omni + **20 dBm hopping** (D-R6 draft, Atenea Q3 yes)	19.0 dBm	+36.5	+13.9	+18.8	+9.9 NM stays at 10 mW

Why one omni

- Covers every direction in NM, including the box at the corner of the two rims, with no aiming
- One radio per box, no patch boards, no VNA tuning, off-the-shelf antenna
- Only ~1 dB behind the patches on MRM once it plugs straight into the SP4

What we give up

- A thin MRM margin (+3.4 dB at 0.75 m). The levers: mount the antenna high (+5 dB per 25 cm), and 20 dBm hopping (D-R6 draft, Atenea Q3: +10.5 dB)
- No sideways rejection of other teams' boxes: the ≥ 10 m spacing of the channel plan still holds, with no extra isolation

Why not the E01-2G4M27D

Its −99 dBm receiver is tempting, but its lowest output is about +9 dBm. Behind a ~3 dBi antenna that is ~12 dBm e.i.r.p., over the 10 mW limit. It would be legal in the 20 dBm hopping mode, but it could not run NM (or the fallback if Atenea says no) at 10 mW, so it stays out.

20 dBm with frequency hopping draft · needs Atenea Q3

CNAF UN-85 has two regimes in 2400–2483.5 MHz `VERIFIED`. **b)** generic low-power devices: under 10 mW e.i.r.p., our baseline. **a)** wideband data systems under EN 300 328: **100 mW e.i.r.p.**, but the density is capped at **100 mW per 100 kHz for frequency hopping** and **10 mW**

per MHz for anything else. Our signal is under 1 MHz wide, so without hopping a) still means ~10 dBm. The 20 dBm needs a hopping radio that follows the EN 300 328 sharing rules.

EN 300 328 V2.2.2 has two kinds of hopping. **Non-adaptive** hopping caps power × duty: at 20 dBm the radio may transmit only 10 % of the time (~16 kbps), too slow for a 2-minute file. **Adaptive hopping with listen-before-talk** has no duty limit, so that is the one we built (D-R6).

EN 300 328 RULE (ADAPTIVE FHSS, LBT)	REQUIREMENT	OUR DESIGN (PHY_CONFIG.PY, ALL CHECKS OK)
RF output power (4.3.1.2)	≤ 20 dBm e.i.r.p.	RF_PWR −12 today: ≤ 15.5 dBm at the worst-case PA gain. If T0 measures the gain at ≤ 23.5 dB, −6 is legal: 16.5–20 dBm.
Hop channels (4.3.1.4)	≥ 15 at all times, over ≥ 70 % of the band	**29 channels**, RF_CH 2–76 (even), 74.6 MHz = 89 % of the band; none within 4 MHz of the other teams' MRM channels 24 / 49 / 82
Time per channel (4.3.1.4)	≤ 400 ms in any 400 ms × N window	25 ms per hop, each channel once per 0.725 s cycle: ≤ 207 ms
Hop separation (4.3.1.5)	≥ 100 kHz	2 MHz between neighbours; consecutive hops ≥ 14 MHz apart
Clear channel check (4.3.1.7.2)	Energy detect ≥ 18 µs before each hop's first frame; ≤ −70 dBm/MHz at 20 dBm (relaxed at lower power)	The nRF24's RPD bit after 170 µs in RX: ~−76 dBm at the SP4 port `ESTIMATE`, needed ≤ −64 dBm at −12 and ≤ −68.5 dBm at 20 dBm. **T17 measures it.**
Channel occupancy (4.3.1.7.2)	< 60 ms per check, then idle ≥ 5 %	50 ms, then 2.5 ms idle; busy hops are skipped

What changes

- **Nothing in the hardware.** The SP4 is a +20 dBm module that we hold at its lowest step; hopping only raises the step.

How we know we qualify

- **Regulation:** the design meets the EN 300 328 adaptive-FHSS rules in the table, at

TX bursts move toward the datasheet's 120 mA, which the radio LDO already covers.

- **Driver:** only the hopping profile may go above −18 dBm. It refuses channels outside the hop set and any frame without a clear check on the current hop, ends each occupancy at 50 ms and waits the idle gap. 194 host checks pass.
- **Protocol:** unchanged; the radio layer hops every 25 ms (one 16-frame burst). Simulator: all 10,000 lines in 36 s with 10 % of hops busy, 54 s with 25 % busy plus a receiver reboot. Still to build on the Pico: finding the sender's hop timing.
- **NM stays on channel 80 at 10 mW.** Hopping in sync across four teams' boxes for a 0.5 kB file is not worth it, and NM has +9.9 dB.

≤ 20 dBm e.i.r.p. measured with our antenna.

- **Course:** the rules require CNAF 2017 compliance and say oral comments do not override the written rules. Marcos posts **Atenea Q3** with this design and copies Prof. Anna Umbert (spectrum regulation). We use 20 dBm only after a written yes.
- **Evidence:** T13 (e.i.r.p.), T17 (where the clear-channel check trips) and T18 (hop pattern, dwell, skipping a busy channel on the analyser), plotted for the ANNEX.
- **Other teams:** we leave our MRM channel (74) and avoid theirs, but we are 10 dB louder next to their boxes. Tell them first.

MODEL AT 0.75 M (WORKBOOK S24–S26)	E.I.R.P.	SRI 70 M	MRM 260 M	MRM AT 0.5 M	MRM AT 1
Baseline, 10 mW, one channel	8.5 dBm	+26.0	+3.4	−3.6	+
Hopping, RF_PWR −6 (if T0 allows)	19.0 dBm	+36.5	+13.9	+6.9	+1
Hopping, worst RF_PWR step (−12)	13.5 dBm	+31.0	+8.4	+1.4	+1

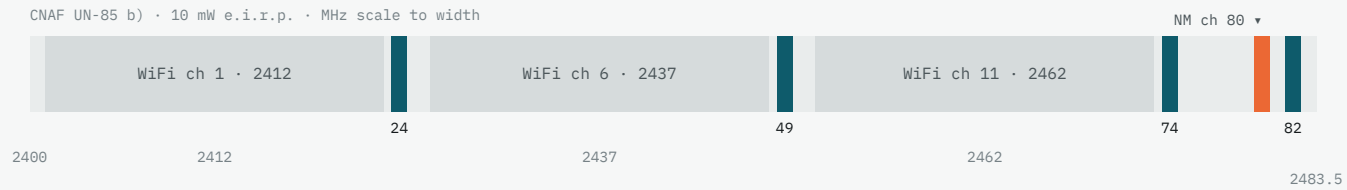
Rules that constrain the radio

- Unlicensed spectrum only, compliant with **CNAF 2017 UN notes**, IEEE C95.1 (RF exposure) and ESD safety. RULE
- **No chip implementing a standard wireless access protocol** (WiFi, Bluetooth, 2G–5G, ZigBee; the Session 1 slide adds NB-IoT and **LoRa**). The nRF24L01+ has none of them. RULE
- **Nothing may stick out of the 15 × 15 × 7 cm IKEA 365+ box** except buttons, switches and connectors, so the antennas go inside. The box sits on a support of **about 70 cm**. RULE

- **Modules shown at Quick Mode are final.** Antennas, batteries and mechanics may still change. RULE
- Distances: SRI **70 m**, teams one after another, 2 minutes; MRM **~260 m, all teams at the same time**, 2 minutes; NM relays along the South and East rims with no line of sight end to end, **5 minutes**. RULE
- Scoring counts only the **first unbroken run of byte-identical lines** (~10,000 lines of ~100 B), so reliability beats raw bit rate. RULE

Spectrum: 2400–2483.5 MHz and our channels

nRF24 channel N sits at 2400 + N MHz, so only **RF_CH 0–83** are legal in Spain; the driver refuses anything higher. Campus WiFi (eduroam) normally uses channels 1, 6 and 11, which leave three gaps. The MRM plan puts three teams in those gaps, 25 MHz apart, and the fourth at the band edge. Test T14 (campus survey) confirms it before we propose it.



MRM channel, one per team (RF_CH) NM common channel typical WiFi occupancy (22 MHz)

BAND	NOTE	MAX POWER	ACCESS CONDITION	STATUS FOR US	COMMENT
2400–2483.5 MHz	UN-85 b)	10 mW e.i.r.p.	none (EN 300 440)	our band	No duty cycle. Eve team gets own chan in MRM. Shared wi campus W and Bluetooth
2400–2483.5 MHz	UN-85 a)	100 mW e.i.r.p.; 100 mW/100 kHz hopping, 10	sharing rules required (EN 300 328)	D-R6 draft · Atenea Q3	A non-hopping narrowba radio gain nothing (1 mW/MHz)

BAND	NOTE	MAX POWER	ACCESS CONDITION	STATUS FOR US	COMMENT
		mW/MHz other			Our SRI/MRM hopping mode with listen-before-tal uses it: +10.5 dB. NM stays under b).
869.40–869.65 MHz	UN-39	500 mW e.r.p.	≤10 % DC	dropped 9 Oct	Better ran but one 25 kHz chann for four simultane teams in MRM and rounds pe hour.
433 / 5725 MHz	UN-30 / UN-130	10 / 25 mW	≤10 % DC / none	not used	433 MHz antenna to long for th box; few cheap nor WiFi parts 5.8 GHz.

Sources: CNAF 2017, BOE-A-2017-12318 · CNAF 2021, BOE-A-2021-21346.

MRM: one channel per team

Our ARQ makes both ends transmit (data one way, ACKs back), and the four teams' boxes stand close together at each end. Another team's box a few metres away is far louder than our partner 260 m away. Whether we still hear our partner depends on how far apart the channels are. The nRF24's selectivity at 250 kbps is **−50 dB beyond 6 MHz** and **−60 dB beyond 25 MHz** (datasheet, table 8) VERIFIED.

OTHER TEAM'S BOX FROM OUR RECEIVER	2 M	5 M	10 M	20 M
Interferer above our 260 m signal, omni antennas (our build)	55 dB	47 dB	41 dB	35 dB
Same with patches side by side (~10 dB rejection each; not our build)	35 dB	27 dB	21 dB	15 dB

CHANNEL PAIR	SPACING	SELECTIVITY	WHAT IT NEEDS
24 / 49 · 2424 / 2449 MHz	25 MHz	−60 dB	safe even at 2 m
49 / 74 · 2449 / 2474 MHz	25 MHz	−60 dB	safe even at 2 m
74 / 82 · 2474 / 2482 MHz	8 MHz	−50 dB	≥ 10 m between these two teams' boxes (9 dB to

Proposal for the inter-team meeting; we ask the organisers for ≥ 10 m between teams at each end anyway. Test T15 checks it with three of our own boxes.

Link budget

This uses the course method: Maxim AN5142 with the course correction (no ½ factor in the flat-earth formula) and the course spreadsheet's worst-case ground bounce (a = 1, |cos|). Inputs:

- antennas at 0.75 m (70 cm support plus position in the box) ASSUMPTION
- −1 dB container loss and 0 dB multipath on open campus paths ASSUMPTION
- flex omni 2 dBi in the box, cable −0.5 dB, in both directions; +7 dBm out of the module ASSUMPTION
- receiver sensitivity from the E01-ML01SP4 datasheet (−96 dBm at 250 kbps) VERIFIED

FLAT-EARTH LINK MARGIN VS DISTANCE · DB ABOVE RECEIVER SENSITIVITY

SP4 + omni · 250 kbps (decided) SP4 + omni · 20 dBm hopping (D-R6 draft)

SP4 + omni · 1 Mbps RFM69 868 MHz · 100 kbps (dropped)



Show as table

SCENARIO	EIRP DBM	RX DBM	SENS. DBM	MARGIN DB	WITH −20 DB MULTIPATH
SRI 70 m | E01-ML01SP4 | 250 kbps, omni · decided	8.5	-70.0	-96.0	+25.9	+6.0
SRI 70 m | E01-ML01SP4 | 1 Mbps, omni	8.5	-70.0	-87.0	+16.9	-3.0
MRM 260 m | E01-ML01SP4 | 250 kbps, omni · decided	8.5	-92.6	-96.0	+3.4	-16.6
NM hop 100 m | E01-ML01SP4 | 250 kbps, -10 dB obstr., omni · decided	8.5	-86.1	-96.0	+9.9	-10.1
MRM 260 m | E01-ML01DP5 | 250 kbps, patches (not chosen)	10.0	-89.6	-94.0	+4.4	-15.6
SRI 70 m | E01-ML01SP4 | 250 kbps, omni, FHSS 20 dBm · D-R6 draft	19.0	-59.5	-96.0	+36.5	+16.4
MRM 260 m | E01-ML01SP4 | 250 kbps,	19.0	-82.1	-96.0	+13.9	-6.1

SCENARIO	EIRP DBM	RX DBM	SENS. DBM	MARGIN DB	WITH −20 DB MULTIPATH
omni, FHSS 20 dBm · D-R6 draft					

Full AN5142 rows are in `radio/MTP-F26_TeamC_Radio_LinkBudget.xlsx` (scenarios S21–S23 are the decided 2.4 GHz baseline, S24–S26 the 20 dBm hopping draft D-R6; S16–S20 the patch option); every cell is a live formula and inputs are in blue. AN5142's default −20 dB multipath is for cluttered paths. Tests T4 and T5 on campus will tell us which number to use.

Antenna height is the biggest lever

At 0.75 m the ground reflection takes over beyond ~18 m at 2.4 GHz. Past that point loss grows 40 dB per decade and hardly depends on frequency: $P_R \approx EIRP \cdot G_R \cdot (h_1 h_2)^2 / d^4$.

Raising both antennas from 0.75 to 1.0 m adds **+5 dB** on MRM. Mount the omni as high on the wall as the box allows. Whether "about 70 cm" allows a taller support is Atenea Q4.

The nRF24 has no RSSI

It only has one bit (RPD) that says "above −64 dBm at the chip", about −74 dBm at the SP4's antenna socket. Range tests therefore measure packet loss, and levels come from the spectrum analyser or the model. RPD still works as listen-before-talk and for the campus channel survey.

Datasheet limits that matter

- **32 B maximum payload:** our frames shrank from 64 B to 32 B (28 B of data). VERIFIED
- **Variable-length frames need the chip's auto-ACK feature on,** so the driver sends every frame as "no ACK": no chip ACKs or retries on air.
- **PA always in line:** no bypass, so the lowest output is +2 to +7 dBm; the driver caps the setting there.

Throughput: does the file fit in 2 minutes?

About 1 MB in 120 s needs **66.7 kbps** of useful throughput. The model assumes selective-repeat ARQ with one ACK per 16 frames and 85 % efficiency for the micro and USB `ASSUMPTION`. The simulator runs the real protocol code over a modelled channel with 5 % random loss, deflate compression, and the nRF24 airtime from the driver.

CONFIGURATION	AIR RATE	GOODPUT (MODEL)	WHOLE FILE (SIM, 5 % LOSS)	LINES, NO COMPRESSI
SP4, 32 B frames (decided)	250 kbps	158.7 kbps	28 s	10,000 (73
SP4, 32 B frames, SRI option	1 Mbps	594.1 kbps	13 s	10,0
RFM69 868 MHz, 64 B frames (dropped)	100 kbps	67.3 kbps	38 s	9,6
RFM69 868 MHz shared by 4 teams in MRM (dropped)	~25 kbps	~17 kbps	–	~2,5

> At 2.4 GHz each team keeps its full rate in MRM, because it has its own channel. That, not range, is why the band switch pays off.

Module shortlist

Read from the primary datasheets on 9 Oct 2026. Prices and EU lead times are still **TO VERIFY**.

MODULE	CHIP	OUT AT THE CONNECTOR	SENSITIVITY	CONNECTOR	PRO
Ebyte E01-ML01SP4 decided	nRF24L01P + PA/LNA	~+2 to +20 dBm	−96 @250k (datasheet)	IPEX on the module	low

MODULE	CHIP	OUT AT THE CONNECTOR	SENSITIVITY	CONNECTOR	PRO
Ebyte E01-ML01DP5 not chosen	nRF24L01P + PA/LNA	~+2 to +20 dBm	~−96 @250k	SMA	low
Ebyte E01-2G4M27D	nRF24L01P + 27 dBm PA	≥ +9 dBm	−99 @250k	SMA	low
Bare nRF24L01+	nRF24L01+	−18 to 0 dBm	−94 @250k	PCB / none	low
TI CC2500 modules	CC2500	+1 dBm	−87 @250k	PCB	low
E01C-*, no-name PA+LNA boards	Si24R1 clone	unknown		SMA	excl
SX1280 / SX1281	LoRa 2.4 GHz	—			excl
Radio SoCs (nRF52, ESP32, CC2652…)	—	—			excl

Decisions and who they touch

DECISION	OWNER	DEPENDS ON	AFFECTS	STATUS
D-R1b Band: 2.4 GHz for every mode, 250 kbps	All teams + Radio	—	Everything radio	agreed by the teams, 9 Oct
D-R2c Radio module (frozen at Quick Mode)	Radio → handed to electronics	T0 output power, T2 sensitivity	PCB, BoM, power supply	decided 13 Oct: E01-ML01SP4 order by Fri 16 Oct
D-R3 NM radio shared by all teams	Radio + protocols	Other teams' modules	NM bonus (+2 to +2.5)	draft v0.2 ready send to teams; freeze by week 6
D-R4 MRM channel per team	Radio + other teams	Campus survey T14	MRM (+1)	draft: 24 / 49 / 74 / 82
D-R6 SRI/MRM as adaptive hopping + listen-before-talk at ≤ 20 dBm e.i.r.p.	Radio + protocols	Atenea Q3, T0 (all steps), T17, T18	MRM (+10.5 dB), firmware, other teams	draft 16 Oct built and tested in sim; needs Q3
D-R5c Antenna: one flex omni (Molex 146153-0100)	Radio	Box inside height, T5	Mechanics, carrier PCB	decided 13 Oct T5 measures the in-box gain

> **Revisit D-R2c if** T0 measures more than ~+7.5 dBm at the lowest setting (the e.i.r.p. limit with a 3 dBi antenna), or T2 shows a clone or a weak receiver. If T0 measures only ~+2 dBm, the module is legal but every margin drops ~5 dB: then raise the antenna and push Atenea Q3 (D-R6 lifts every link by up to 10.5 dB on the same module).

Handoff to electronics

One **E01-ML01SP4** per box. SMD, 10 pads at 1.27 mm: 1 VCC, 2 CE, 3 CSN, 4 SCK, 5 MOSI, 6 MISO, 7 IRQ, 8–10 GND (Ebyte manual §3). No traces under the module on the top layer.

PIN	AT THE MICRO	WHAT MATTERS
`VCC, GND`	supply	**2.0–3.6 V only**, never the battery rail (a Li-ion cell reaches 4.2 V). Use a dedicated 3.3 V LDO for the radio (≥ 300 mA), and 100 µF + 10 µF + 100 nF at the module. 120 mA in TX, 26 mA in RX.
`SCK MOSI MISO`	SPI master	Mode 0, MSB first, ≤ 10 MHz.
`CSN`	GPIO out	Chip select, active low.
`CE`	GPIO out	High = receive; a ≥ 10 µs pulse sends one frame.
`IRQ`	GPIO in, optional	Active low: frame sent / frame received. The driver polls today.
`IPEX`	—	The flex omni plugs in here. Keep the module near the antenna wall and away from the battery, USB and the 5 V boost.

Proposed Pico 2 pins: SPI0 GP16/18/19, CSN GP17, CE GP20, IRQ GP21. The SP4 needs a small breakout (or the carrier PCB) from the first bench test, because the Quick Mode module is final. Needed back from electronics: OK on the module and the radio LDO, who makes the breakout, the pin map, a power check, and the box's inside height.

Shared NM radio settings: draft for all teams

Plain nRF24L01+ register settings, so any team's nRF24 board can join with a few register writes and no shared code.

SETTING	VALUE	WHY
Channel	`RF_CH 80 · 2480 MHz`	Clear of WiFi 1/6/11 and of the four MRM channels
Rate	`250 kbps`	Best sensitivity and selectivity; NM moves only ~0.5 kB
Address	`5 B · C2 5A 9D 3E 71`	Different from every team's own address
Frames	dynamic length 1–32 B, hardware CRC-16	Same on every nRF24L01+

SETTING	VALUE	WHY
ACKs	none on air: send with "no ACK", retries 0	Chip ACKs from several receivers would collide
Power · polarisation	≤ 10 dBm e.i.r.p. · vertical	Legal limit; mismatched polarisation costs 10–20 dB
Channel access	listen before talk with RPD, random back-off	The nRF24 has no carrier sense in hardware

Interop test before week 6: every pair of boxes exchanges 1 000 frames at 10 m on RF_CH 80; pass is ≥ 99 % with a valid end-to-end CRC. Full proposal: `radio/NM_PHY_PROPOSAL.md`.

Test plan

No duty-cycle limit, so tests can be repeated freely. Stay at RF_PWR −18 dBm until T0; the hopping profile stays in the lab until Atenea Q3 is answered and T17/T18 pass. For each run, record place, profile, channel, distance, heights, antenna, box open or closed, pad, and frames sent and received.

TEST	WHAT	PASS	WHEN
T0	Bring-up, then **conducted output power at all four settings** on the spectrum analyser (U.FL-to-SMA pigtail, ≥ 30 dB attenuator)	Driver starts; output ≤ +7.5 dBm at −18, so e.i.r.p. ≤ 10 dBm with the 3 dBi antenna. The other steps pick the hopping mode's power. **Gate for any field test.**	modules arrive
T2	Sensitivity at 250 kbps and 1 Mbps through a lab step attenuator	1 % packet loss at **≤ −92 dBm** (250 kbps). **Gate for the module.**	before Quick Mode
T14	Campus 2.4 GHz survey with the RPD bit, channels 0–83, at each site	Our MRM channels and the NM channel busy < 5 %	before the inter-team meeting
T4	Range, open box, 10 / 70 / 150 / 260 m; then one 2-min transfer at 70 m	≤ 1 % loss to 150 m; all 10,000 lines	after T2

TEST	WHAT	PASS	WHEN
T13	Spectrum analyser: carrier offset, occupied bandwidth on channel 82, e.i.r.p.	Below 2483.5 MHz; ≤ 10 dBm (≤ 20 dBm hopping). Plot in the ANNEX.	book the lab
T17	D-R6: input level where the clear-channel check (RPD) trips, from a signal generator	≤ the threshold for our power (−64 dBm at −12, −68.5 dBm at 20 dBm)	with T13
T18	D-R6: hop pattern, dwell and occupancy on the analyser; skips a channel with a CW interferer on it	29 channels, ≤ 25 ms dwell, ≤ 50 ms per check, busy channel skipped	with T13
T5	Closed box; antenna high vs middle of the wall; box rotated 0 / 90 / 180°	≤ 1 % loss at 260 m	after T4
T15	MRM near-far with a third box on channel 82 and 49 at 2 m and 10 m	≤ 1 % loss on the 260 m link	after T5

EXPECTED (MODEL)	10 M	70 M	150 M	260 M
SP4 + omni · level	−56 dBm	−70 dBm	−83 dBm	−93 dBm
SP4 + omni · margin	+40 dB	+26 dB	+13 dB	+3 dB

Next: to Fri 23 Oct

ITEM	DATE ASG.	ASSIGNED TO	DESCRIPTION	STATUS	DUE DATE	END DATE	RESULT
R7	09/10/26	RT + PM	Band, module and antenna decisions	Done	16/10/26	13/10/26	2.4 GHz (09/10); SP4 + one omni (13/10)
R12	13/10/26	RT → ET	Order 6 × E01-ML01SP4, 4 × Molex 146153-	Open	16/10/26		

ITEM	DATE ASG.	ASSIGNED TO	DESCRIPTION	STATUS	DUE DATE	END DATE	RESULT
			0100, 2 × U.FL-to-SMA pigtails				
R13	09/10/26	Andrian	Campus 2.4 GHz survey (T14) at the SRI, MRM and NM sites	Open	16/10/26		
R14	09/10/26	RT	MRM channel plan + NM radio settings v0.2 to the other teams' leaders	Open	16/10/26		
R9	13/10/26	RT → ET	Electronics handoff v0.3 reviewed; pin map, radio LDO, SP4 breakout and box height back	Open	16/10/26		
R15	16/10/26	Marcos	Post Atenea Q3 (20 dBm hopping, D-R6 draft), copy Prof. Anna Umbert	Open	23/10/26		
R16	16/10/26	RT → teams	Tell the other teams we may hop in MRM (we leave 74, avoid 24 / 49 / 82)	Open	23/10/26		
R11	04/10/26	RT	Tests T0 and T2 done; D-	Open	before QM		

ITEM	DATE ASG.	ASSIGNED TO	DESCRIPTION	STATUS	DUE DATE	END DATE	RESULT
			R2b confirmed or reversed				

Questions to ask

Atenea forum (posted by the project leader)

- **Allowed chips.** Is the nRF24L01+ on the Ebyte E01-ML01SP4 allowed? Its packet format is Nordic-proprietary and it has no Bluetooth.
- **20 dBm with hopping (Q3, updated 16 Oct).** May our SRI/MRM mode (29-channel adaptive hopping with listen-before-talk per EN 300 328, ≤ 20 dBm e.i.r.p. measured; NM at 10 mW) use UN-85 a)? What evidence do you want? Worth +10.5 dB on MRM.
- **Support height and box.** Is the support fixed at 70 cm? May the box stand on its 15 × 7 cm edge?
- **Cooperation.** May teams agree a common NM radio and an MRM channel split, sharing settings but not code?

Consultants

- **Anna Umbert** (spectrum regulation): does the D-R6 hopping design qualify for UN-85 a) at 20 dBm? Which plots (power, hop pattern, clear-channel threshold) should go in the ANNEX?
- **Concepción Santos / Carles Puente** (antennas): placing a flex omni inside a plastic box on a 70 cm support; measuring its in-box gain at the lab; effect of the battery, the foil and hands.
- **Paradells / Perelló** (protocols, with the protocols team): one channel per team in MRM and listen-before-talk in NM.

Files: `radio/MTP-F26_TeamC_Radio_LinkBudget.xlsx` (hand-in link budget, live formulas) · `radio/linkbudget.py` (same model, plus the MRM near-far printout) · `radio/phy_config.py` (radio profiles and checks) · `radio/fw/` (nRF24 driver and tests) · `radio/DECISIONS.md`, `HANDOFF_ET.md`, `NM_PHY_PROPOSAL.md`, `TEST_PLAN.md`, `ATENEA_QUESTIONS.md`. Repo: github.com/SantiBarrios2002/mtp-f26-teamc.

Primary sources: competition rules PDF (MTP F26, Network Upgrade III + Sustainability); Session #1 slides; AN5142 with the course annotations; CNAF 2017/2021 (BOE); nRF24L01+ Product Specification v1.0; Ebyte E01-ML01SP4, E01-2G4M27D and E01C manuals; Molex 146153 and Taoglas FXP73 antenna listings.